



CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Digital Marketing for Startups

Positioning, content, social media, funnels, paid campaigns, email, analytics, and growth experiments

PARTNER LEARNING SERIES

Learn how startup marketing turns customer understanding into messages, channels, campaigns, experiments, measurable acquisition, and compounding growth.

CareerSense Partners • marketers • founders • creators • business professionals

CareerSense Learning Series • careersenseai.com/resources

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Handbook

Learn how startup marketing turns customer understanding into messages, channels, campaigns, experiments, measurable acquisition, and compounding growth.

What each chapter contains

Each chapter follows the same learning rhythm used across the CareerSense Academy series: a concise introduction, learning objectives, plain-English concepts, CareerSense examples, professional habits, common mistakes, quick revision notes, practice questions, and hands-on exercises.

PARTNER PROMISE The examples are designed to prepare you for real CareerSense Partner assignments. Do not memorize terminology. Learn to create useful work products: audits, reports, prototypes, dashboards, campaigns, strategies, and decisions.

Recommended practice approach

- Read the relevant chapter before starting the matching Partner assignment.
- Use CareerSense or a safe sample environment to practise whenever possible.
- Keep evidence: screenshots, notes, links, spreadsheets, queries, designs, or metrics.
- Document assumptions and limitations instead of hiding uncertainty.
- Finish each chapter by completing at least one hands-on exercise.

CONTENTS

What You Will Learn

Chapter	Topic
01	Marketing Strategy and Positioning
02	Funnels and Customer Journeys
03	Content Strategy and Social Media
04	Paid Media and Landing Pages
05	Email and Lifecycle Marketing
06	Analytics and Attribution
07	Growth Experiments
08	CareerSense Capstone: 30-Day Growth Sprint

Closing the book: quick revision sheet • glossary • professional habits • 20-question quiz • answer key • next steps.

CHAPTER 01

01

Marketing Strategy and Positioning

Marketing strategy decides who matters, what promise is distinctive, why it is credible, and where the audience can be reached.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define target audiences
- Create positioning
- Connect customer pain to messaging
- Distinguish strategy from tactics

Core idea

Marketing strategy decides who matters, what promise is distinctive, why it is credible, and where the audience can be reached.

Professional perspective

Positioning should make the product category, customer, problem, value, and differentiation easy to understand.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

CareerSense can position differently for students, working professionals, universities, and partners instead of using one generic message.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Define target audiences.
- Create positioning.
- Connect customer pain to messaging.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of marketing strategy and positioning?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to marketing strategy and positioning using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 02

02

Funnels and Customer Journeys

A marketing funnel tracks movement from awareness to consideration, activation, conversion, retention, and referral.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Map awareness to retention
- Define conversion events
- Identify leakage
- Measure activation

Core idea

A marketing funnel tracks movement from awareness to consideration, activation, conversion, retention, and referral.

Professional perspective

The most important event is often not signup but the first moment users experience real value.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

For CareerSense, activation might be completing the first resume, ATS analysis, interview, or career readiness assessment.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Map awareness to retention.
- Define conversion events.
- Identify leakage.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of funnels and customer journeys?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to funnels and customer journeys using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 03

03

Content Strategy and Social Media

Content works when it repeatedly educates, demonstrates, proves, or inspires around audience problems.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build content pillars
- Write hooks and CTAs
- Choose formats by channel
- Create editorial systems

Core idea

Content works when it repeatedly educates, demonstrates, proves, or inspires around audience problems.

Professional perspective

A content calendar should balance evergreen education, product proof, community, trends, and conversion.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

CareerSense can build recurring series around ATS, interviews, AI-ready careers, salary negotiation, and partner journeys.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

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QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Build content pillars.
- Write hooks and CTAs.
- Choose formats by channel.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of content strategy and social media?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to content strategy and social media using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 04

04

Paid Media and Landing Pages

Paid campaigns should connect a specific audience, promise, creative, landing page, and conversion event.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Understand campaign structure
- Define audiences
- Write ad hypotheses
- Improve landing conversion

Core idea

Paid campaigns should connect a specific audience, promise, creative, landing page, and conversion event.

Professional perspective

CTR alone is insufficient. Evaluate cost per qualified action and downstream behavior.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A Resume Builder campaign should not send every click to the generic homepage; use a focused landing page and track completed resumes.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Understand campaign structure.
- Define audiences.
- Write ad hypotheses.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of paid media and landing pages?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to paid media and landing pages using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 05

05

Email and Lifecycle Marketing

Lifecycle marketing responds to user stage: welcome, activation, education, re-engagement, upgrade, completion, and referral.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build onboarding sequences
- Segment audiences
- Write lifecycle messages
- Respect consent

Core idea

Lifecycle marketing responds to user stage: welcome, activation, education, re-engagement, upgrade, completion, and referral.

Professional perspective

Good email programs reduce dependence on paid acquisition by improving activation and retention.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

CareerSense student onboarding could guide users from profile completion to first resume, first interview, and readiness score.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Build onboarding sequences.
- Segment audiences.
- Write lifecycle messages.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of email and lifecycle marketing?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to email and lifecycle marketing using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 06

06

Analytics and Attribution

Marketing analytics connects spend and activity to user behavior. Attribution is imperfect, so teams should use consistent tracking and avoid false precision.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use UTMs
- Read channel metrics
- Distinguish correlation and attribution
- Create campaign dashboards

Core idea

Marketing analytics connects spend and activity to user behavior. Attribution is imperfect, so teams should use consistent tracking and avoid false precision.

Professional perspective

Measure impressions, clicks, qualified visits, activation, conversion, CAC, retention, and revenue where relevant.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A partner campaign report should show both reach and actual CareerSense actions generated.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Use UTMs.
- Read channel metrics.
- Distinguish correlation and attribution.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of analytics and attribution?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to analytics and attribution using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 07

07

Growth Experiments

Growth teams run disciplined experiments rather than random tactics. Each test should specify audience, change, expected behavior, metric, duration, and next decision.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Write growth hypotheses
- Prioritize tests
- Set decision rules
- Document learnings

Core idea

Growth teams run disciplined experiments rather than random tactics. Each test should specify audience, change, expected behavior, metric, duration, and next decision.

Professional perspective

Failed experiments are valuable when they produce reusable learning.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Test whether a clearer 'Try each tool once free' message increases activation without reducing paid conversion.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Write growth hypotheses.
- Prioritize tests.
- Set decision rules.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of growth experiments?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to growth experiments using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 08

08

CareerSense Capstone: 30-Day Growth Sprint

Design a 30-day CareerSense campaign across at least three channels. Include audience, positioning, calendar, creatives, landing page concept, tracking plan, and KPI dashboard.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build a campaign plan
- Create content assets
- Run or simulate campaigns
- Report performance

Core idea

Design a 30-day CareerSense campaign across at least three channels. Include audience, positioning, calendar, creatives, landing page concept, tracking plan, and KPI dashboard.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Deliver the campaign deck, 10 posts, 5 short-video concepts, 3 ad concepts, email sequence, and results or expected benchmarks.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Build a campaign plan.
- Create content assets.
- Run or simulate campaigns.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of careersense capstone: 30-day growth sprint?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to careersense capstone: 30-day growth sprint using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CLOSING THE BOOK

Course Summary

You have worked through the professional foundations of digital marketing for startups. The purpose of this handbook is not to make you fluent in vocabulary; it is to help you complete real work with stronger judgment, structure, evidence, and communication.

**PROFESSIONAL
TAKEAWAY**

CareerSense Partners should be able to explain not only what they did, but why it mattered, what evidence supported it, what trade-offs existed, and what measurable action should happen next.

Digital Marketing for Startups - Quick Revision Sheet

Topic	Remember
Marketing Strategy and Positioning	Define target audiences
Funnels and Customer Journeys	Map awareness to retention
Content Strategy and Social Media	Build content pillars
Paid Media and Landing Pages	Understand campaign structure
Email and Lifecycle Marketing	Build onboarding sequences
Analytics and Attribution	Use UTMs
Growth Experiments	Write growth hypotheses
CareerSense Capstone: 30-Day Growth Sprint	Build a campaign plan

Glossary

Term	Plain-English meaning
Runway	How long a company can operate before available cash is exhausted.
Burn	Net cash consumed over a period.
Unit economics	Revenue and cost structure associated with serving one unit or customer.
ICP	Ideal Customer Profile - the organization or user segment most likely to be a strong fit.
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost.
CTR	Click-through rate.
Conversion	A desired action completed by a user.
Search intent	The underlying goal behind a search query.
Outcome	A measurable change in user, customer, or business behavior.
Metric	A quantitative measure used to monitor performance or progress.
Hypothesis	A testable statement about what change is expected and why.
Stakeholder	A person or group affected by or able to influence an initiative.
MVP	The smallest trustworthy version that tests an important assumption.
KPI	A key performance indicator tied to an important objective.
Iteration	A cycle of building, measuring, learning, and improving.
Trade-off	Choosing one benefit or priority while accepting a cost elsewhere.
Evidence	Observed information that supports or challenges a decision.
Prioritization	Deciding what deserves attention and resources first.

20-Question Practice Quiz

1. What is one core principle from 'Marketing Strategy and Positioning'?
9. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Marketing Strategy and Positioning' in a real assignment?
2. What is one core principle from 'Funnels and Customer Journeys'?
10. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Funnels and Customer Journeys' in a real assignment?
3. What is one core principle from 'Content Strategy and Social Media'?
11. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Content Strategy and Social Media' in a real assignment?
4. What is one core principle from 'Paid Media and Landing Pages'?
12. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Paid Media and Landing Pages' in a real assignment?
5. What is one core principle from 'Email and Lifecycle Marketing'?
13. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Email and Lifecycle Marketing' in a real assignment?
6. What is one core principle from 'Analytics and Attribution'?
14. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Analytics and Attribution' in a real assignment?
7. What is one core principle from 'Growth Experiments'?
15. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Growth Experiments' in a real assignment?
8. What is one core principle from 'CareerSense Capstone: 30-Day Growth Sprint'?
16. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'CareerSense Capstone: 30-Day Growth Sprint' in a real assignment?
17. Why should recommendations be tied to evidence?
18. What is the difference between an activity and an outcome?
19. Why should assumptions and limitations be documented?
20. What makes an assignment deliverable useful to leadership?

Answer Key

1. A strong answer should explain define target audiences and connect it to an observable decision or result.
9. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
2. A strong answer should explain map awareness to retention and connect it to an observable decision or result.
10. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
3. A strong answer should explain build content pillars and connect it to an observable decision or result.
11. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
4. A strong answer should explain understand campaign structure and connect it to an observable decision or result.
12. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
5. A strong answer should explain build onboarding sequences and connect it to an observable decision or result.
13. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
6. A strong answer should explain use utms and connect it to an observable decision or result.
14. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
7. A strong answer should explain write growth hypotheses and connect it to an observable decision or result.
15. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
8. A strong answer should explain build a campaign plan and connect it to an observable decision or result.
16. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
17. Evidence separates a useful recommendation from an unsupported opinion.
18. An activity is work performed; an outcome is the change produced by that work.
19. Documenting assumptions makes uncertainty visible and allows reviewers to judge the strength of the conclusion.
20. A useful deliverable is clear, evidence-based, actionable, appropriately scoped, and tied to an owner or next decision.

CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Keep Building

You now have a working foundation in digital marketing for startups. Use this handbook as a reference before and during your Partner assignments. Professional capability grows when you repeatedly turn concepts into useful outputs, receive feedback, and improve your judgment.

NEXT STEPS

- Choose the CareerSense Partner assignment most closely related to this handbook.
- Review the relevant chapter before beginning.
- Complete the assignment with traceable evidence.
- Ask for feedback on both the result and your decision process.
- Add the finished work to your Partner portfolio where permitted.

**CAREERSENSE
PARTNER
LEARNING PATH**

Learn → Apply → Document → Review → Improve → Lead.

More CareerSense learning resources

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